

Can I be?

The ground floor. Whether the world holds you, or whether you are holding yourself up.

“Can I be... here... now?”

1

Protection

Somewhere you are not braced. Not the absence of danger, but a place you can rest.

Where in your life do you feel safe enough to put your guard down? And where does the ground feel least solid under you?

LÄNGLE ASKS IT THIS WAY

Do I enjoy protection, acceptance, do I feel at home somewhere?

2

Space

Room to exist without justifying it. Physical room, and the other kind.

Where do you have room simply to be, without having to earn it or explain it? Where do you feel pressed in?

LÄNGLE ASKS IT THIS WAY

Do I have enough space for being there?

3

Support

What holds when you stop holding yourself up. A chair, a person, a routine, the floor.

When things give way, what holds? Who or what can you actually lean your weight on?

LÄNGLE ASKS IT THIS WAY

Where do I find support in my life?

When it is missing: restlessness, insecurity and fear.

How to use it

Four weeks, one Fundamental Motivation a week, in order. They build on one another: the second assumes the first, and the fourth assumes all three. It is worth keeping them in sequence.

- | | |
|--------------------|---|
| 1. TUNE IN | Listen to the meditation for that Fundamental Motivation. Nothing to answer yet. |
| 2. SIT | Two or three minutes afterwards with nothing happening. This is part of it. |
| 3. REFLECT | Three questions, one per prerequisite. Write by hand if you can. |
| 4. LEAVE IT | Come back to the page later in the week and add what surfaced. The first answer is rarely the whole answer. |

Please listen to the meditation before you look at the questions. It is there to put you in contact with what the questions are about, so that the answers come from somewhere a little deeper than what you already think about yourself. Each meditation folds in the ones before it, and they get longer: fifteen minutes at the first, forty-five at the last. That lengthening is deliberate. It is gentle practice for holding your attention inwards for the kind of stretch a journey will ask of you.

IF A QUESTION COMES UP EMPTY

Some of these questions may come up empty, and that is worth as much as a full page. Perhaps more. An empty line is telling you something, and it does not require you to do anything about it today. You can just sit with it for now. And if several come up empty at once, or if what surfaces is more than you want to hold on your own, I encourage you to take it to someone before you take it into a journey: a therapist, a doctor, or a person who knows you well.

Two honest questions

What if I do not have four weeks?

Then do them in whatever time you have, still in order, even if that is four evenings. The order carries the argument; the calendar does not. But notice that wanting to compress the preparation is itself worth a line on the page.

What if I am not planning a journey at all?

The twelve conditions are not about psychedelics. They are Längle's account of what a person needs in order to say yes to their own life, and they were being asked in consulting rooms for decades before anyone pointed them at this. Use them anyway.



The four meditations

Free, and published with DOIs under the same licence as this sheet. Fifteen to forty-five minutes each.
research.aestra.ca/ea-meditations